

# SIMATS ENGINEERING

## ASSESSMENT TOOL 2

COURSE NAME: Artificial Intelligence

COURSE CODE: CSA1709

### CO1-AT2-Constraint-Based Problem Solving

|                 |           |
|-----------------|-----------|
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#### COURSE OUTCOME COVERED

**CO1:** Apply AI basics such as intelligent agents and uninformed search methods to solve problems effectively.( BL3)

Assessment Tool Weightage: 20%

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**QUESTIONS:3**

**Total Marks:30**

1. A hospital needs to assign 3 doctors (D1, D2, D3) to 3 shifts (Morning, Afternoon, Night) such that:

Constraints:

- D1 cannot work Night shift
- D2 must work before D3 (Morning < Afternoon < Night)
- Only one doctor per shift
- D3 cannot work Morning
- All doctors must be assigned exactly one shift

Apply Backtracking Search to find a valid assignment with all intermediate steps and constraint checks. State the final valid schedule

2. A robot operates in a grid environment (5×5). It must move from Start (S) to Goal (G). Obstacles block certain paths.

Constraints:

- Movement allowed: Up, Down, Left, Right
- Cost of each move = 1
- Cannot pass through obstacles
- Use Manhattan Distance heuristic

Using above constraints and BFS Search Algorithm Show step-by-step node expansion and priority queue updates and determine the optimal path and cost.

3. An autonomous rescue robot is deployed in a disaster-affected building to locate and rescue survivors. The robot operates in a partially observable environment where some paths are blocked, and it must make decisions with limited information. The building is represented as a grid of rooms. The robot starts at position S and must reach a survivor located at G.

Constraints:

- The robot can move up, down, left, right

- Some cells are blocked (obstacles) and cannot be traversed
- The robot has limited sensing capability (can only observe adjacent cells)
- Each movement has a cost of 1, but entering risky zones has an additional cost of 2
- The robot must minimize total cost while ensuring safe navigation
- The robot must update its knowledge dynamically (online search scenario)

Tasks:

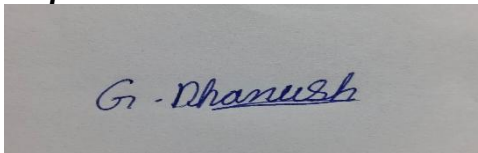
- Analyze all the given constraints and explain how they affect the robot's decision-making process.
- Develop a solution approach using an appropriate search strategy (e.g., Uniform Cost Search / Online Search Agent). Clearly explain the steps involved.
- Demonstrate how the robot applies AI concepts such as:
  - Intelligent agents
  - Rationality
  - Environment type
- Justify why your chosen approach is the most suitable for solving this problem under the given constraints.

### **Code of Conduct:**

*I \_Dhanush.G (192512132)\_\_\_ (Name / Reg No) certify that this submission is my original work and that I have adhered to the guidelines specified for this assessment.*

*I understand that any violation of academic integrity rules will result in disciplinary action.*

**Signature of the student:**



### **RUBRICS FOR CALCULATION:**

| Criterion                    | Level 4<br>(Exemplary)                                                         | Level 3<br>(Proficient)                               | Level 2<br>(Developing)                       | Level 1<br>(Beginning)                   | Max<br>Marks |
|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|--------------|
| Criteria                     | Level 4<br>(Exemplary)                                                         | Level 3<br>(Proficient)                               | Level 2<br>(Developing)                       | Level 1<br>(Beginning)                   | Max Marks    |
| <b>Problem Understanding</b> | Clearly defines the problem and identifies all relevant constraints accurately | Identifies most constraints with minor gaps           | Partial understanding; misses key constraints | Fails to identify constraints correctly  | 6            |
| <b>Constraint Analysis</b>   | Analyzes constraints effectively and prioritizes them logically                | Provides reasonable analysis with some prioritization | Limited analysis; weak prioritization         | No meaningful analysis or prioritization | 6            |
| <b>Solution Development</b>  | Develops optimal and feasible                                                  | Develops workable solutions with minor limitations    | Solutions partially satisfy constraints       | Solutions do not meet constraints        | 7.5          |

|                                |                                                                    |                                          |                                        |                                   |     |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-----|
|                                | solutions satisfying all constraints                               |                                          |                                        |                                   |     |
| <b>Application of Concepts</b> | Effectively applies appropriate concepts, methods, or tools        | Applies concepts with minor errors       | Limited application; requires guidance | Unable to apply relevant concepts | 6   |
| <b>Justification</b>           | Provides strong justification for decisions with logical reasoning | Provides justification with some clarity | Weak or unclear justification          | No justification provided         | 4.5 |

1.

### ANSWER: Hospital Doctor Assignment using Backtracking Search

**Given**

Doctors: **D1, D2, D3**

Shifts:

- Morning (M)
- Afternoon (A)
- Night (N)

**Constraints**

1. D1 cannot work Night.
2. D2 must work before D3 (Morning < Afternoon < Night).
3. Only one doctor per shift.
4. D3 cannot work Morning.
5. Every doctor must be assigned exactly one shift.

#### Step 1: Initial State

No doctor is assigned.

**Doctor Shift**

D1 -  
D2 -  
D3 -

#### Step 2: Assign D1

Possible shifts:

- Morning ✓
- Afternoon ✓
- Night X (Constraint violated)

Choose

**D1 = Morning**

Current Assignment

**Doctor Shift**

D1 Morning  
D2 -  
D3 -

Constraint Check

- D1 not Night ✓

### Step 3: Assign D2

Remaining shifts

- Afternoon
- Night

Try

**D2 = Afternoon**

Current Assignment

**Doctor Shift**

D1     Morning

D2     Afternoon

D3     -

Constraint Check

- One doctor per shift ✓

### Step 4: Assign D3

Remaining shift

Night

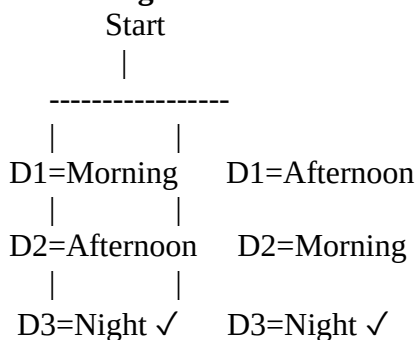
Check constraints

- D3 not Morning ✓
- D2 before D3 (Afternoon before Night) ✓
- One doctor per shift ✓
- All doctors assigned ✓

Hence,

**Solution Found**

### Backtracking Search Tree



If any assignment violates a constraint, the algorithm **backtracks** and tries another assignment.

### Algorithm

Backtracking(Assignment)

If all doctors assigned

Return Solution

Choose an unassigned doctor

For each available shift

If constraints satisfied

Assign shift

Call Backtracking()

If solution found

Return Solution

Remove assignment

Return Failure

### **Final Schedule**

#### **Doctor Shift**

D1 Morning

D2 Afternoon

D3 Night

### **Time Complexity**

Worst Case

**$O(n!)$**

where n is the number of variables.

2.

### **ANSWER: Robot Grid using BFS Search**

#### **Grid**

S . . X .

. X . X .

. X . . .

. . X X .

X . . . G

#### **Legend**

- S = Start
- G = Goal
- X = Obstacle

#### **Movement**

- Up
- Down
- Left
- Right

Cost = 1

### **Manhattan Distance**

#### **Formula**

$h(n) = |x - x_g| + |y - y_g|$

#### **Example**

At Start

$$|4-0|+|4-0|=8 \quad |4-0|+|4-0|=8 \quad |4-0|+|4-0|=8$$

Goal

000

### BFS Algorithm

1. Put Start into Queue.
2. Remove first node.
3. Expand neighbours.
4. Ignore visited nodes.
5. Ignore obstacles.
6. Add valid nodes to Queue.
7. Repeat until Goal is reached.

### Queue Updates

Step 1

Queue

[(0,0)]

Expand

(0,0)

Queue

[(0,1),(1,0)]

Step 2

Expand

(0,1)

Queue

[(1,0),(0,2)]

Step 3

Expand

(1,0)

Queue

[(0,2),(2,0)]

Step 4

Expand

(0,2)

Queue

[(2,0),(1,2)]

### Time Complexity

$O(V + E)$

where V = vertices and E = edges.

3.

ANSWER: Rescue Robot using Uniform Cost Search

(a) Constraint Analysis

Constraint

Effect

Four-direction movement Robot explores adjacent cells only.

| <b>Constraint</b> | <b>Effect</b>                               |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Obstacles         | Robot finds alternate routes.               |
| Limited sensing   | Learns environment while moving.            |
| Cost = 1          | Every movement increases path cost.         |
| Risk cost = +2    | Robot avoids dangerous cells.               |
| Online updates    | Replans when new information is discovered. |

### **(b) Uniform Cost Search**

Algorithm

1. Start from S.
2. Insert into Priority Queue.
3. Remove lowest-cost node.
4. Expand neighbours.
5. Calculate

Cost = Previous Cost + Move Cost + Risk Cost

6. Update Queue.
7. Repeat until Goal.

### **Example**

Safe Cell

Current Cost = 4

Move = 1

Total = 5

Risk Cell

Current Cost = 4

Move = 1

Risk = 2

Total = 7

Robot chooses the lowest-cost path.

### **(c) AI Concepts**

#### **Intelligent Agent**

- Perceives surroundings.
- Plans path.
- Learns new information.
- Reaches survivor safely.

#### **Rational Agent**

**Chooses the action that minimizes total travel cost while maximizing safety.**

Environment Type

Property      Type

Observability Partially Observable

Agent              Single Agent

|             |            |
|-------------|------------|
| Property    | Type       |
| Environment | Dynamic    |
| Decision    | Sequential |
| Knowledge   | Unknown    |

#### **(d) Justification**

##### **Uniform Cost Search is suitable because:**

- Produces the minimum-cost path.
- Considers risky zones and movement costs.
- Replans when new obstacles are detected.
- Suitable for partially observable environments.
- Ensures safe and efficient rescue.

##### **Advantages**

- Optimal solution.
  - Handles variable costs.
  - Supports online navigation.
  - Reduces risk.
  - Efficient for disaster environments.
- 
- Q1: Backtracking successfully assigns doctors while satisfying all constraints. Final schedule: D1–Morning, D2–Afternoon, D3–Night.
  - Q2: BFS explores the grid level by level and finds the shortest path from Start to Goal with cost = 8.
  - Q3: Uniform Cost Search with an Online Search Agent enables the rescue robot to navigate safely in a partially observable environment, minimizing total cost while adapting to newly discovered obstacles.